

VS Code & IDLE

Installation & Python Development Setup

Windows • Beginner Friendly • Step-by-Step

Step 1 — Download Python

Python 3.14.7 is the latest Python 3 release listed by Python.org as of August 2026.

Open Python.org → Downloads → Windows.

Choose the current recommended Windows installation method.

For traditional installer-based teaching labs, use the appropriate Windows installer when available.

Official source: python.org/downloads/windows/

Step 2 — Install Python

Run the downloaded Python installer.

Enable the option to add Python to PATH when using the traditional installer.

Choose Install Now for a simple setup, or Customize installation for advanced options.

Wait for the installation to complete.

Restart Command Prompt/PowerShell after installation if it was already open.

Step 3 — Verify Python

Open Command Prompt or PowerShell.

Check the installed Python version:

```
python --version
```

You can also try the Python launcher command:

```
py --version
```

Step 4 — Open Python IDLE

Click Start and search for “IDLE”.

Open “IDLE (Python 3.x ...)”.

The Python Shell window opens.

Use the Shell for quick experiments and the Editor window for saving .py programs.

Step 5 — First Program in IDLE

In IDLE, select File → New File.

Type the following program:

```
print("Hello, Python!")
```

Save as: hello.py

Press F5 or choose Run → Run Module.

The output appears in the Python Shell.

Step 6 — Download VS Code

Use the official Visual Studio Code website.

Open the official VS Code download page.

Choose Windows User Setup for most users.

User setup normally does not require administrator permission.

Download the .exe installer and run it.

Step 7 — Install VS Code

Accept the license agreement.

Choose the installation location.

Keep the recommended options unless you have a specific requirement.

Finish the installation and launch VS Code.

VS Code User Setup adds the code command to PATH; restart the terminal before using code from it.

Step 8 — Install the Python Extension

Open VS Code.

Click the Extensions icon on the left sidebar.

Search for “Python”.

Install the Python extension published by Microsoft.

The extension provides Python editing, IntelliSense, debugging and interpreter selection.

Step 9 — Select the Python Interpreter

Press Ctrl + Shift + P to open the Command Palette.

Search for: Python: Select Interpreter

Choose the Python installation you installed.

If multiple versions are listed, select the version you intend to use for the course/project.

Step 10 — Create Your First VS Code Project

Create a folder such as Python_Programs.

Open VS Code → File → Open Folder.

Create a new file named hello.py.

Enter the Python code and save the file.

Use the Run Python File button or the integrated terminal.

Run Python in VS Code

```
print("Hello from VS Code!")
```

Method 1: Click the Run Python File button.

Method 2: Right-click the editor → Run Python File in Terminal.

Method 3: Use the terminal command: `python hello.py`

You're Ready to Code!

IDLE → Python basics

VS Code → Projects, debugging & professional workflow

Practice • Build • Debug • Repeat